



School of Arts and Sciences
School of Engineering

Sp26-TML-0193-08-Special Topics - Josep Puig Ruiz

Project Title: **Spring 2026 AS&E Course Evaluation**

Courses Audience: **23**

Responses Received: **13**

Response Ratio: **56.52%**

Summary of Results

The Course

Question	Course		Subject (TML)	
	Mean	Standard Deviation	Mean	Standard Deviation
5. Based on your answers above, and any other factors you consider important, please provide an overall evaluation of the course.	4.77	0.60	4.40	0.88
Overall	4.77	0.60	4.40	-

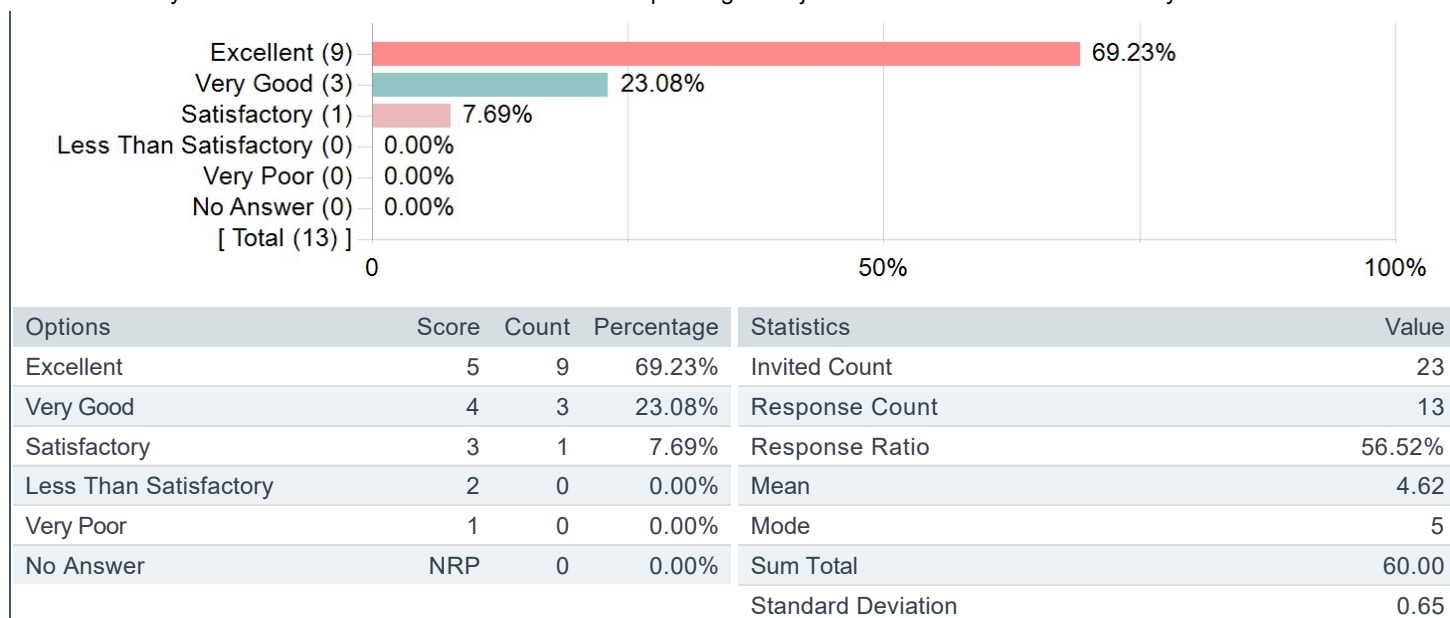
The Instructor

Question	Course		Subject (TML)	
	Mean	Standard Deviation	Mean	Standard Deviation
15. Based on your answers above, and any other factors you consider important, please provide an overall evaluation of the instructor.	4.85	0.38	4.52	0.81
Overall	4.85	0.38	4.52	-

Detailed Results of Course Evaluation

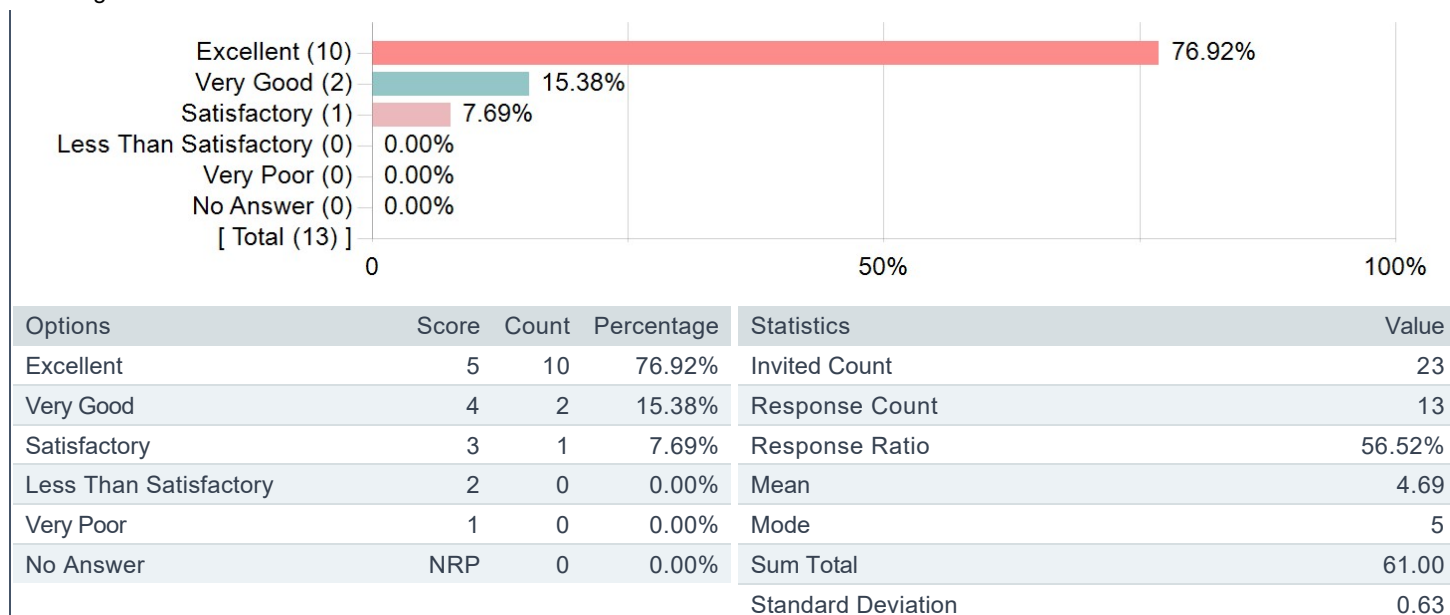
1. How would you rate the success of the course in accomplishing its objectives as stated on the course syllabus?

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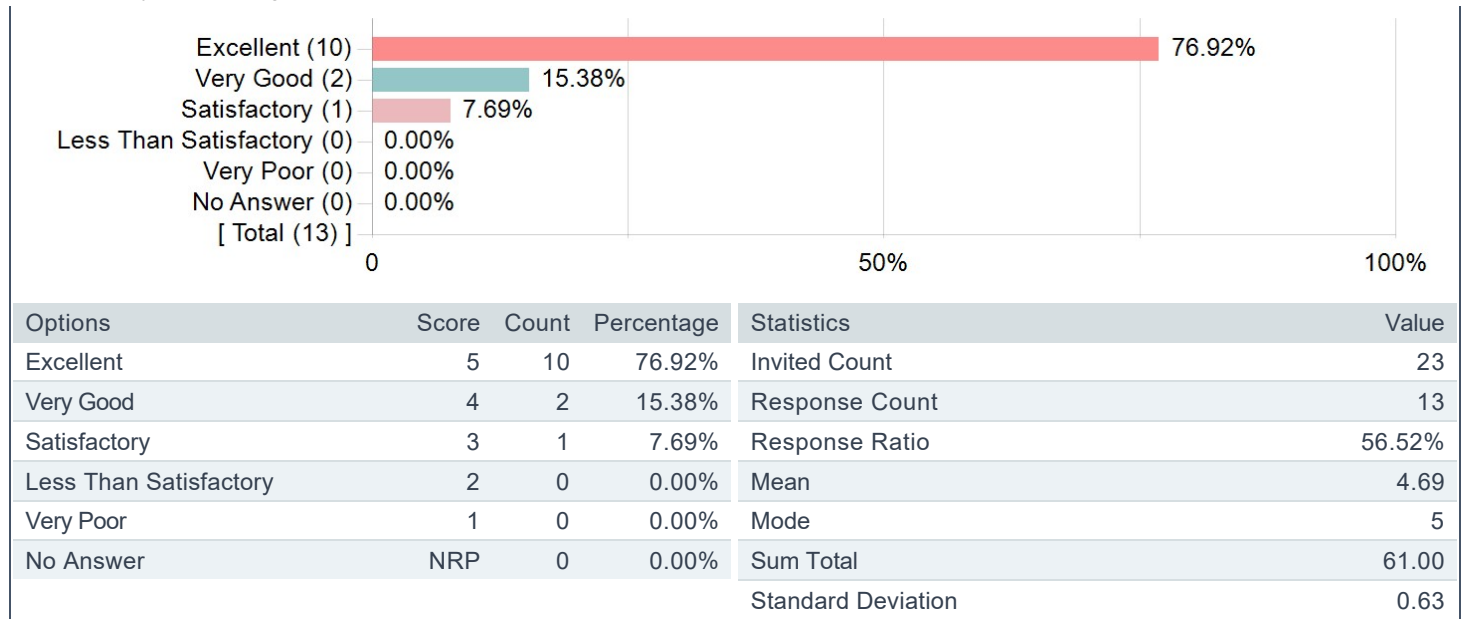
2. How would you rate the use of class time (lectures, discussions, demonstrations, labs, studio work, etc.) to promote your learning?

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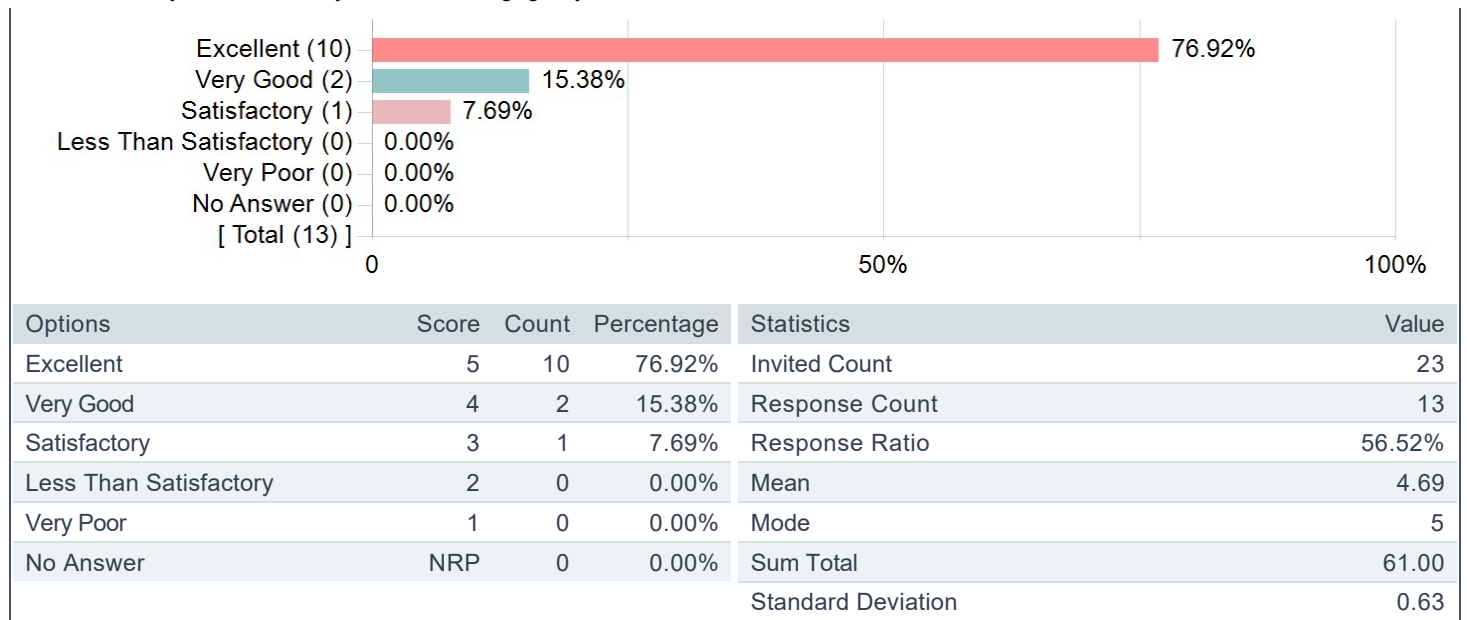
3. How would you rate the use of out-of-class activities (reading assignments, homework, papers, projects, studio art practice, etc.) to promote your learning?

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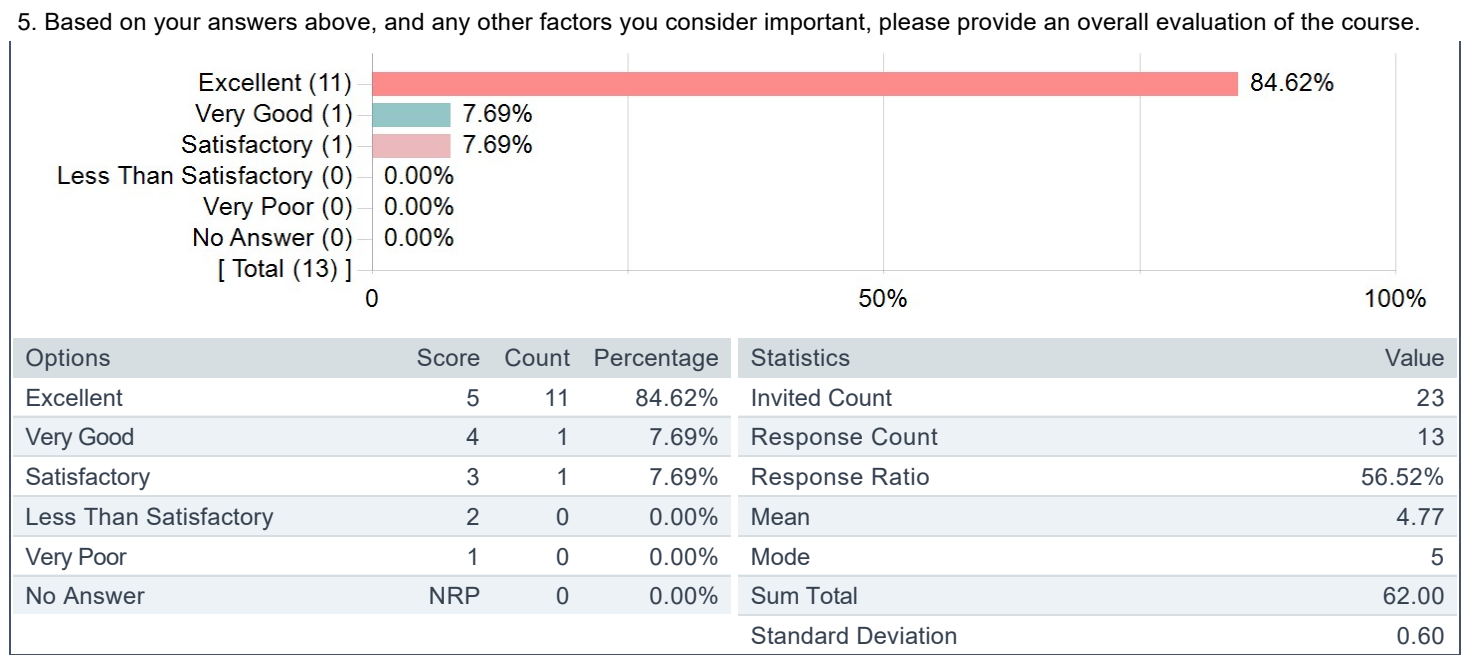


4. How would you rate the way the course engaged your interest?

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5. Based on your answers above, and any other factors you consider important, please provide an overall evaluation of the course.



6. In what ways has this course made you think differently or more deeply? Please provide examples.

Comments
I had no idea financial data engineering could be so FUN! I learned about options, futures, derivatives, and other concepts on the CFA exam that I would have never learned about earlier if not for the course. I also really appreciated your honesty and genuine excitement about your work. It was my first time seeing someone in their career so excited and interested in teaching others about what they find interesting in the world.
There was no course like this offered at Tufts so just the course it self was great. Also the mini lectures by each students of different concepts were great.
This is my first applied class. It was very engaging due to the lectures Josep gave that were industry focused.
Certain topics covered were completely new to me and I had lots of fun expanding my view of the world by learning them. The kind of assignments we had also made me think more deeply and pay attention to detail.

7. What aspects of this course worked best to facilitate your learning?

Comments
I really enjoyed the student presentations, final and the volunteering ones, and the papers and extra resources you pointed us toward. I tried to join the NVIDIA call conference but couldn't make it on the day – seeing how real time and cutting edge the content we were discussing in class was with my own eyes, I was astonished! The lectures, with the 5 minute breaks and the snacks was great and I think a really well done job for the first time teaching.
Class final presentation and the students presentations
Having access to the slides, example problems, and guided homeworks
The capstone project, homework assignments, and in–class discussions were all highlights of the course. The capstone in particular was an effective way to engage with the course material, and the assignments reinforced concepts at a reasonable pace. The discussions made the content feel relevant and grounded in real market context.
Lectures, homework
HWs were very long, but super rewarding.
Homeworks and projects

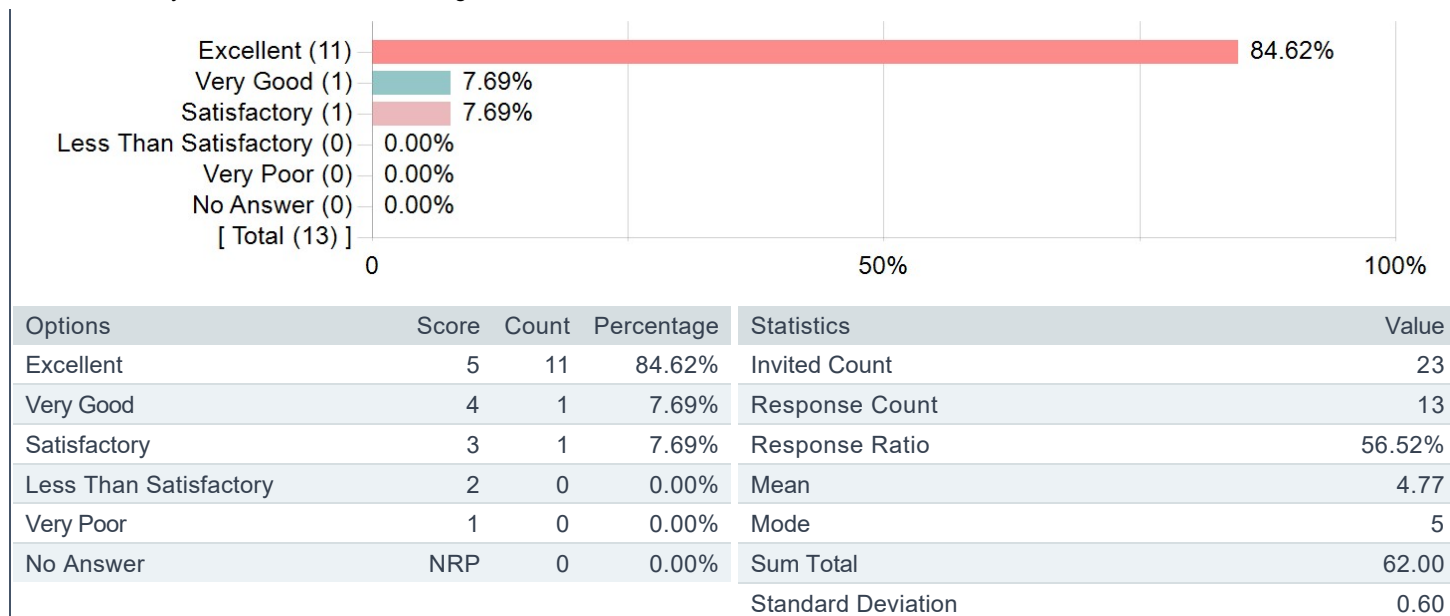
8. What suggestions do you have for improving this course?

Comments
I would suggest including some content as additional reading/appendix slides (like: read more if you want to) in case we aren't able to get through all the slides.
In first assignment maybe giving more of a briefing, and talking about storage.
Having summary slides that highlight key takeaways.
The course would benefit from spending less time on the theoretical aspects of options and futures/forward contracts. While these are clearly important topics, three lectures on the theory left little room to explore their data science applications, which is where the most value lies for this course specifically. Adding prerequisite coding course(s) (such as CS-11 and/or CS-15) and economics course(s) (such as EC-8/EC-5 Principles of Economics and/or EC-50) would allow Josep to cover more ground at a faster pace. A significant portion of the semester was spent building foundational knowledge that a prerequisite would handle, which meant some of the more interesting and advanced material had to be cut short.
This school should have more courses that apply data science to different disciplines!

Detailed Results of Instructor Evaluation

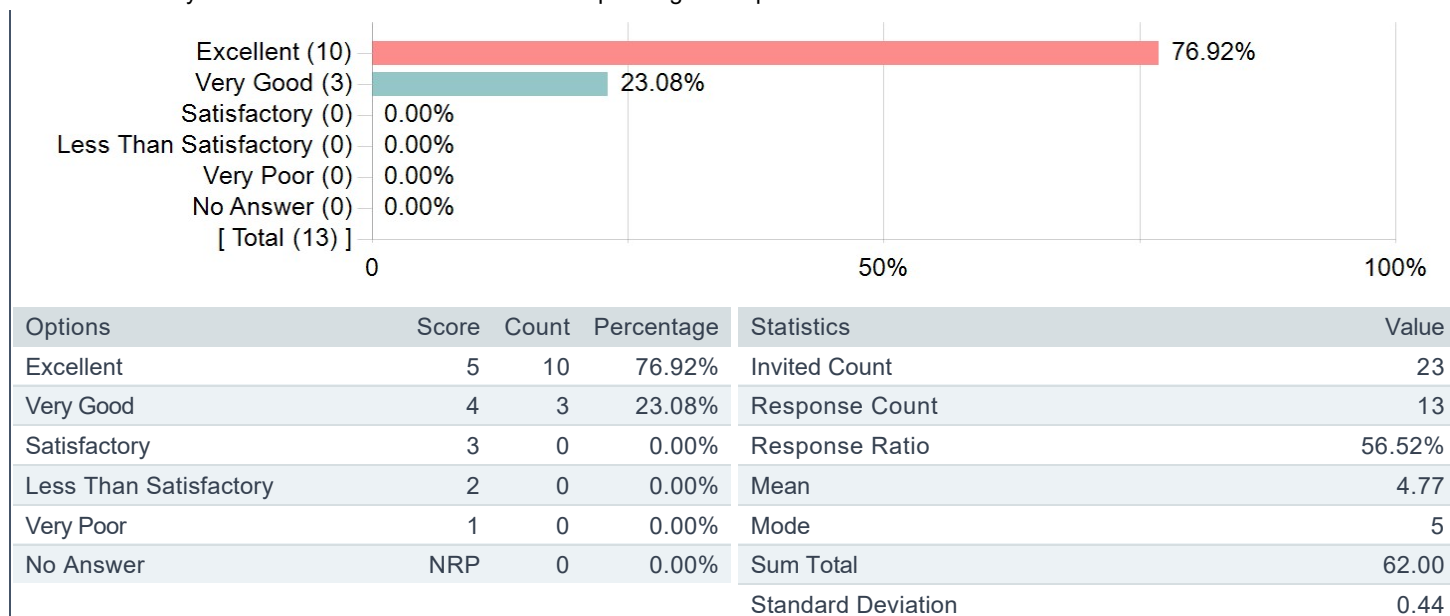
9. How would you rate the instructor's organization of each class?

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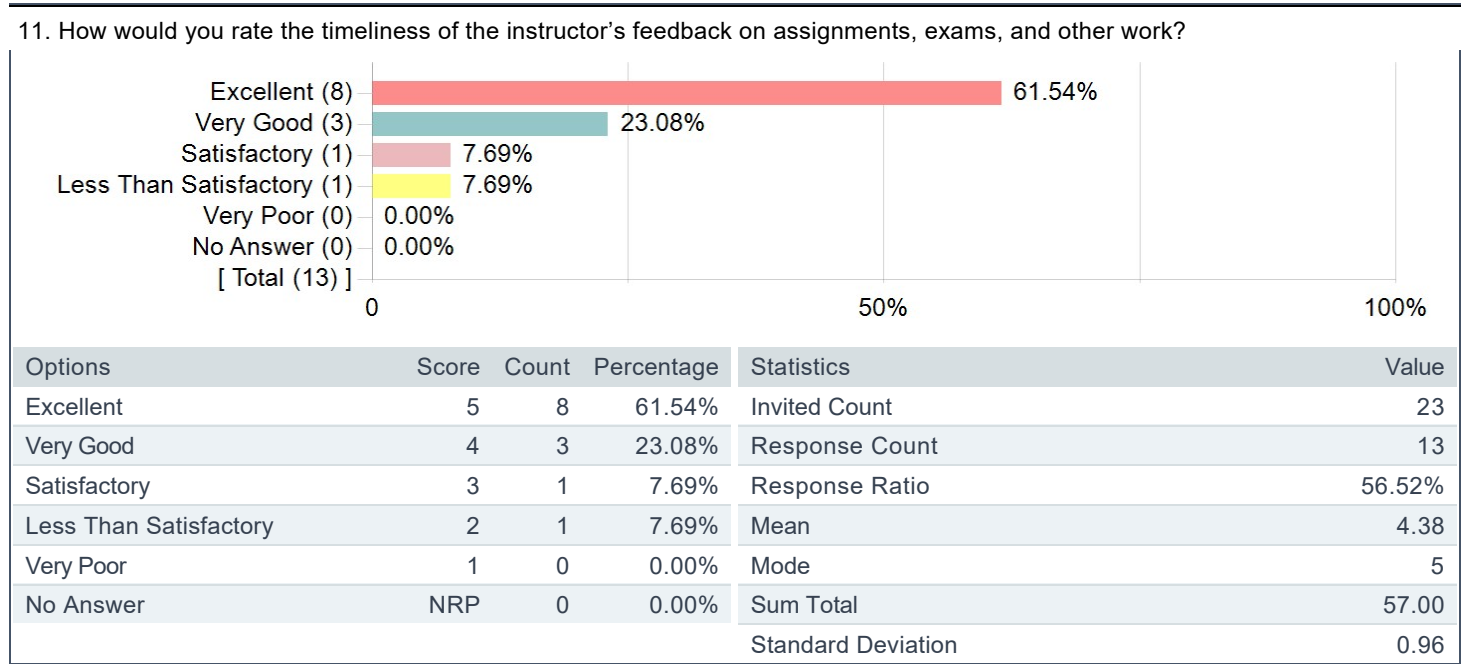


10. How would you rate the instructor's success in explaining concepts and ideas?

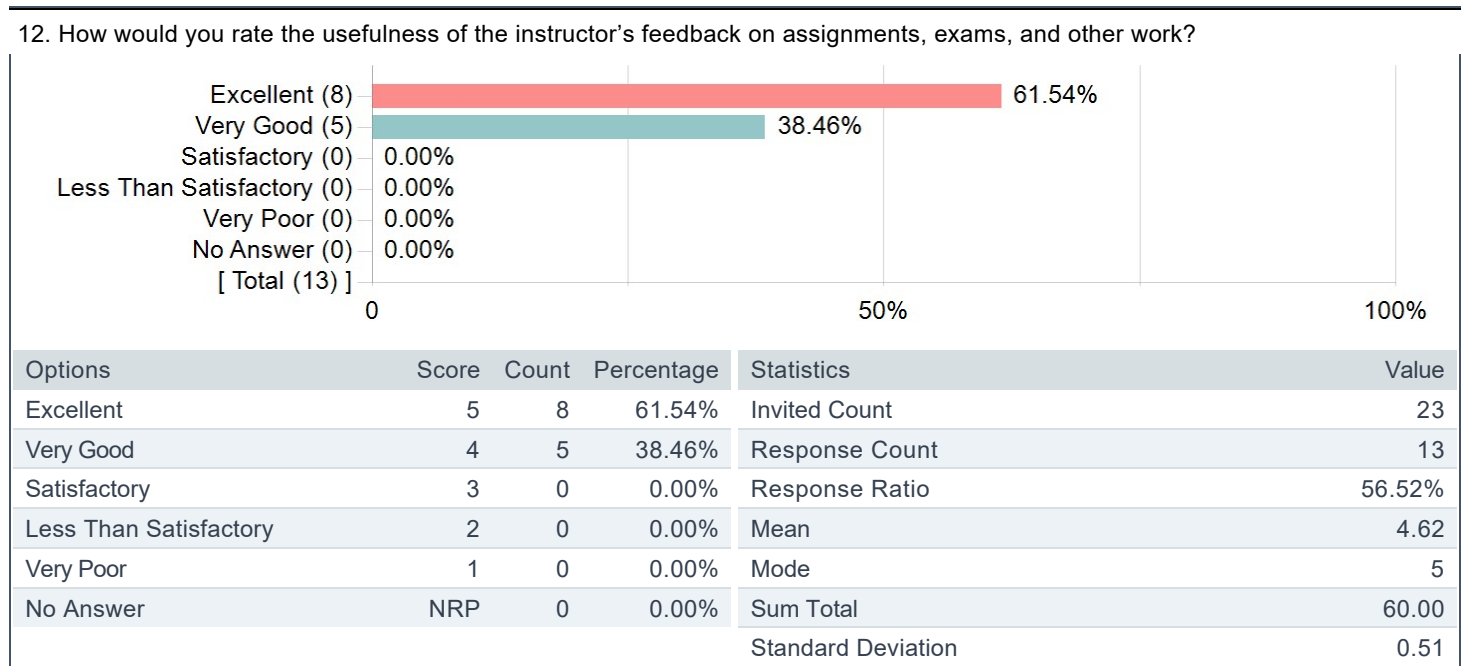
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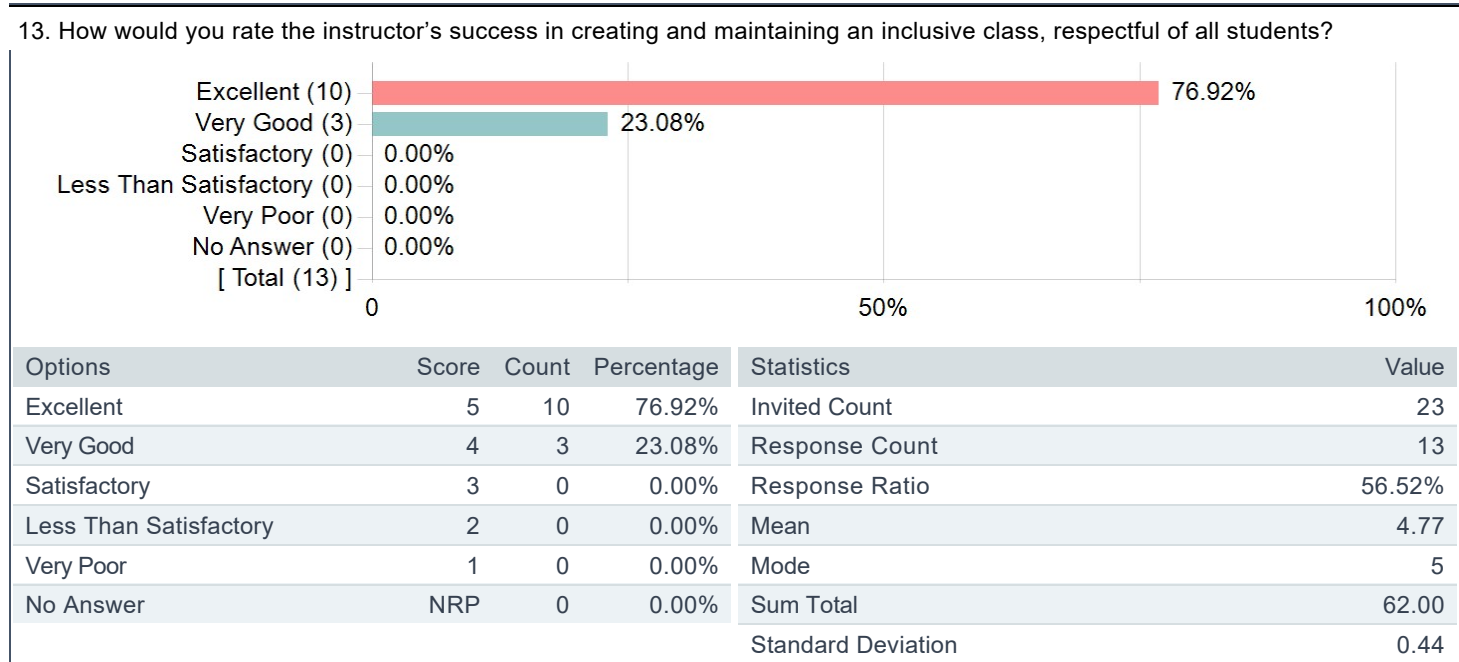
11. How would you rate the timeliness of the instructor’s feedback on assignments, exams, and other work?



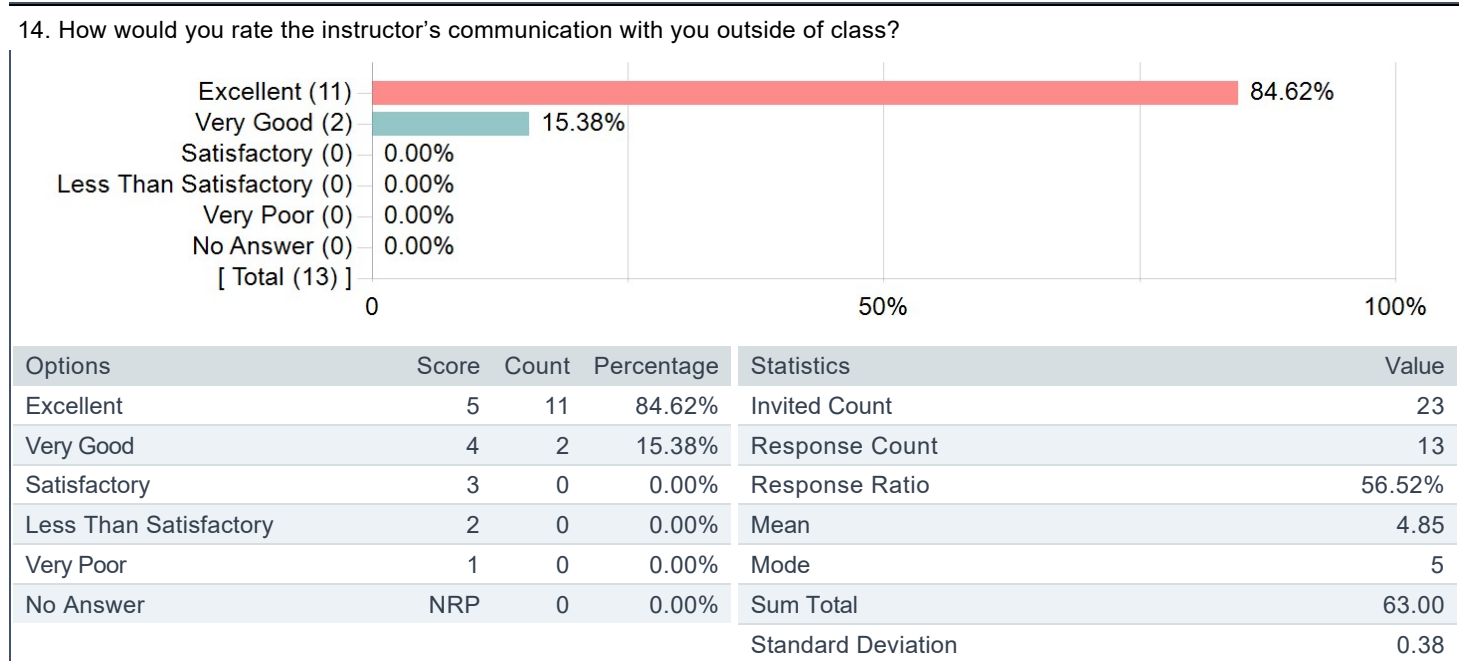
12. How would you rate the usefulness of the instructor’s feedback on assignments, exams, and other work?



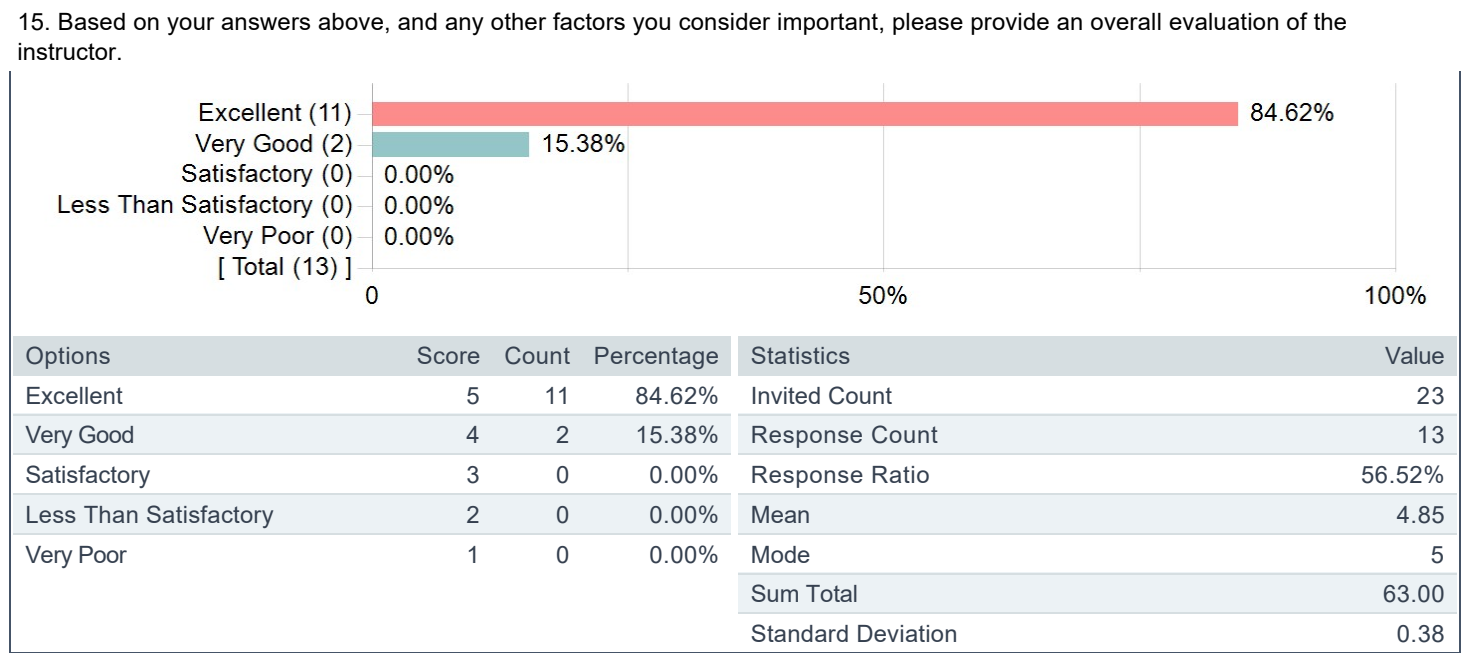
13. How would you rate the instructor's success in creating and maintaining an inclusive class, respectful of all students?



14. How would you rate the instructor's communication with you outside of class?



15. Based on your answers above, and any other factors you consider important, please provide an overall evaluation of the instructor.



16. Please provide any additional comments regarding the instructor.

Comments
World class! This class was my favorite this semester, and I remember sitting in each class, just so amazed that I was learning about the cool stuff that was accessible to me in such a digestible format. I consider myself very lucky to have been taught by Josep!
Instructor was engaging and fun.
Josep was a great teacher.
Passion is evident and is able to highlight interesting aspects of complex material. Very willing to support and explain any concept and homework.
Josep is one of the best professors I have had at Tufts. He is clearly knowledgeable and passionate about the subject, and his motivation to teach students what he saw missing in his own experience working with interns and new graduates made the course feel genuinely purposeful. His ability to explain complex concepts in an accessible way, regardless of a student's background in economics or data science, is a real strength. I would strongly encourage him to return to teach this course and potentially others if he has the bandwidth.
My only suggestions are minor. He speaks quickly, so slowing down occasionally would help with retention. However, since time is limited, posting slides before class would allow students to follow along on their own devices, annotating and highlighting what stands out to them rather than spending the whole time copying down the base content verbatim and missing the smaller insights and memory aids he mentions out loud.
Great professor, super helpful, has a lot of knowledge to share, all at night after working full time in boston. Lot of respect for that
I thought the instructor was very thorough in his topics, and I learned a ton in this class!
Very accommodating and eager to help, answer questions.

17. How would you rate the space in which instruction occurred (classrooms, laboratories, etc.)?

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